



Sinpex Hack Challenge

Challenge Briefing · June 12–13, 2026 · Munich

1 Background

Every KYB (Know Your Business) workflow starts with one precise question: which specific legal entity are we onboarding, and can we prove it is who they say they are?

Sinpex resolves this today in two layers: a fast index lookup in Moody's, falling back to direct queries against official registries when the index misses. The index has coverage gaps and lags reality. Direct lookups are accurate but slow and expensive per query. Neither layer reasons about the messy inputs compliance teams actually receive — partial names, transliterations, trading names, and jurisdictions that turn out to be wrong.

2 The Challenge

How can LLMs make KYB company identification more precise, more complete, and more verifiable than today's index-driven search — without inventing facts?

Three angles worth exploring:

- **Federated retrieval** across heterogeneous national registries that do not share a schema.
- **Structured extraction** of company identifiers and key attributes.
- **Auditable answers** — every claim citable to a source that a compliance officer can verify without redoing the work.

3 Input & Output Format

You will receive a CSV file. Each row is one search query:

Field	Description
query_id	Stable ID (p001, p002, ... / h001, ...) so judges can refer to rows.
name	Company name: may be partial, abbreviated, or fuzzy.

jurisdiction	ISO country code, or state/province code for USA & Canada.
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Required output (minimum) for each query, same index:

Field	Description
query_id	Joins to input.
registry_id	Official registration number from the relevant registry.
registry_court	Specific court or registry office (required for DE, AT, etc.).
name_normalized_register_name	Full legal name as registered (e.g., "Sinpex GmbH", not "Sinpex").
jurisdiction_confirmed	Confirmed country or state/province.
confidence	A number in [0, 1] reflecting how sure your system is. Used for calibration scoring.
source	At least one citable URL or registry document reference supporting the answer.
no_match_reason	If registry_id is blank, why: not_in_registry, ambiguous_candidates, out_of_scope, or your own short label.

4 Tips and edge cases

Registry structure is not uniform across the world. Most teams lose points by ignoring sub-jurisdictional structure or by inventing IDs for entities that have none.

Sub-jurisdictional structure. Some *registry_id* values are not globally unique:

- **Germany.** The Handelsregisternummer is scoped to one of about 150 local courts (Amtsgerichte / Registergerichte). HRB 12345 at Amtsgericht Berlin-Charlottenburg is a different company from HRB 12345 at Amtsgericht München. Always return the Registergericht. The two divisions matter: HRA (partnerships, sole proprietorships) vs HRB (corporations – GmbH, AG).
- **Austria.** Same pattern – the Firmenbuchnummer is scoped to a Firmenbuchgericht.
- **Switzerland.** Cantonal Handelsregister offices, harmonized through Zefix. The UID (CHE-...) is unique nationally.
- **USA.** Company formation is state-level via each Secretary of State. There is no federal company registry. DBA / "fictitious name" filings often live at the county level. Sole proprietors are not separately registered.

- **Canada.** Federal Corporations Canada plus thirteen provincial and territorial registries. A federal corporation may also need to register extra-provincially in each province where it operates.
- **UAE.** Emirate-level registries (DED Dubai, ADCCI Abu Dhabi, free-zone authorities). There is no single federal company registry.

Sole proprietors and freelancers vary wildly. The correct answer is often "no registry entry":

- **Has a public registry.** Poland (CEIDG for sole proprietors and freelancers; KRS for legal entities). France (SIREN is issued to every business, including micro-entrepreneurs and auto-entrepreneurs). Czech Republic (Živnostenský rejstřík). Belgium (KBO / BCE includes natural persons doing business).
- **No central registry.** UK sole traders, Irish sole traders, Spanish autónomos, US sole proprietors. For these, the correct output is a blank registry_id with no_match_reason=not_in_registry. An invented ID is the worst possible answer.

Useful cross-jurisdictional sources. GLEIF for LEI lookups. OpenCorporates for unified access across roughly 180 million entities, including dissolved ones. EU BRIS for cross-border searches across EU member-state registries. OpenOwnership for beneficial-ownership data where it is published. The **catch**: these sources are incomplete and often out-of-date, so they are best used as one signal among many rather than the single source of truth.

Hallucination economics. A confident wrong registry_id is worse than a blank one. The scoring rubric makes this concrete.

5 UI & Automation

Your submission **must** run end-to-end. Given the test CSV as input, it produces the result CSV with no manual steps — no copy-paste, no per-row prompting, no human pasting URLs.

This is an **eligibility gate**, not a scored dimension. We do not score "polished file upload" or "nice CSV download," because any team with a working search API can wrap it in a ten-line Python script — that is not where the points come from.

The UI exists so judges can see your system *think*: search experience, live queries, intermediate candidates, confidence reasoning, and source citations. Build the UI to make your reasoning visible, not to move files around.

6 Datapoints — Extra Points

Score higher by enriching further. Fields are grouped so you can prioritize.

- **Tier A: often public.** Registered address, incorporation date, legal type (GmbH, S.A., LLC, ...), company status (active/dissolved/dormant / in liquidation), Capitalization, Business purpose, VAT number, Trade names, Industry code (Nace) and industry name
- **Tier B: partial coverage.** Officers, directors, legal representatives, and signatories.
- **Tier C: hardest.** Ultimate Beneficial Owners (UBOs). Following the 2022 European Court of Justice ruling (joined cases C-37/20 and C-601/20), public access to EU UBO registers was restricted to requesters with a "legitimate interest." UBO data outside the UK and a few other jurisdictions is no longer trivially scrapeable in 2026 — handle this honestly rather than guessing.

7 Scoring

Weight	Type	Criterion
1 / 4	Objective	Did you find the right legal entity? A hallucinated registry_id is penalized more than a correct one is rewarded. An honest no-match is neutral.
1 / 4	Objective	Per field, per query. Wrong enrichment penalized; blank-but-honest is neutral. Tier A fields are weighted more heavily than Tier B and C fields.
1 / 4	Subjective	The scoring rubric rewards abstention and penalizes confident wrong answers. Confidence is used for calibration scoring, but the real test lies in the downstream impact of hallucinated vs. blank answers.
1 / 4	Subjective	How do you think about the problem? What data sources did you use? How did you prevent hallucination? Judged by the Sinpex management team.

8 Timeline

- **Kickoff.** Challenge briefing, 20 practice cases released.
- **During the hackathon.** Build, test, iterate using the practice set.

- **~1-2 hours before end.** Full test set of 20-50 queries released. Your solution must run automatically.
- **Final presentations.** Walk the jury through your approach, data sources, and results.

9 Rules & logistics

- **Template.** A GitHub repo with a deployable template is provided. You are free to change everything. If deployment breaks completely, ask for help.
- **Freedom.** Any LLM, framework, or data source is permitted. No data sources are prescribed.
- **Precision over recall.** Leave a field blank rather than guessing.

Three practical suggestions:

- **Understand the problem before you start coding.** Search is largely solved — the challenge is in the details of registry structure, edge cases, and hallucination prevention. Build a strong intuition for the problem before jumping into code.
- **Decide your abstention policy on day one.** Knowing when your system should say "I don't know" is more valuable than another point of recall.
- **Pick one jurisdiction first.** UK Companies House is free, well-documented, and in English. Get an end-to-end pipeline working with one jurisdiction before federating across many.
- **Wire confidence and source through the full stack early.** Adding fields later is easy; retrofitting calibration is hard.

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